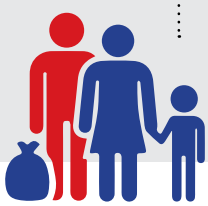
ON MIGRATION

"THEY'RE POISONING THE BLOOD OF OUR COUNTRY.... NOT JUST SOUTH AMERICA, THEY'RE COMING INTO OUR COUNTRY FROM AFRICA, FROM ASIA, ALL OVER THE WORLD"

—Dec. 17, 2023, New Hampshire

"IMMEDIATELY UPON TAKING THE OATH OF OFFICE, I WILL LAUNCH THE LARGEST DEPORTATION PROGRAM IN AMERICAN HISTORY"

—Oct. 23, Duluth, Georgia



ON TARIFFS

"THESE PEOPLE ARE THE SHARPEST.... THEY'RE AT THE TOP OF THEIR GAME, AND THEY USE IT AGAINST US. BUT INDIA IS TOUGH. BRAZIL IS VERY TOUGH...CHINA IS THE TOUGHEST OF ALL, BUT WE'RE TAKING CARE OF CHINA WITH THE TARIFFS"

"SO WHEN INDIA, WHICH IS A VERY BIG ABUSER.... HE (MODI) HAPPENS TO BE COMING TO MEET ME NEXT WEEK, AND MODI, HE'S FANTASTIC. I MEAN, FANTASTIC MAN"

—Sept. 18, Michigan

ON FOREIGN POLICY

"THEY'RE DYING, RUSSIANS AND UKRAINIANS. I WANT THEM TO STOP DYING. AND I'LL HAVE THAT DONE...I'LL HAVE THAT DONE IN 24 HOURS"

—May 2023, CNN Town Hall

"IF WE HAD A REAL PRESIDENT, A PRESIDENT THAT WAS RESPECTED BY PUTIN...HE WOULD HAVE NEVER INVADED UKRAINE"

—July 2024

"GET IT (ISRAEL-HAMAS CONFLICT IN GAZA STRIP) OVER AND LET'S GET BACK TO PEACE AND STOP KILLING PEOPLE"

—Radio interview in April 2024

while Reagan recognised there was a diffusion of power and there were things that the president could or could not do, Trump, Ganguly fears, "is likely to steamroller those kinds of normative institutional procedural constraints". The same is likely to be true of his foreign policy agenda as well, as the new president will try to ram through his disruptive agenda.

THE NEW WORLD DISORDER

But what *is* the world according to Trump? Simply put, it is ensuring America's interests first with those of every other nation coming a very distant second. Trump is unabashed about his transactional approach to key issues and is convinced that America's decline was because it ended up paying everyone else's bills to maintain the global order while the US itself got diminishing returns. As he puts it, "these guys ate our lunch". Despite the American economy doing well under Biden, Trump's campaign theme of high retail prices and low job growth got him the support of the working-class American, who felt the pinch the most. Equally resonant was his amplification of the perceived threat posed by immigrants, especially illegal ones, who would take away American jobs. Among the first things he promises to do when he takes charge in January 2025 is to execute "the largest deportment program" of illegal immigrants ever undertaken.

IN THIS TERM TOO, TRUMP'S DOMESTIC AGENDA WILL BE HIS MOST COMPELLING CONCERN. HIS FOREIGN POLICY WILL HINGE ON THE RADICAL REFORMS HE HAS IN MIND FOR HIS COUNTRY

More than anything else, however, Trump is hell-bent on dismantling America's international statecraft which, after World War II, fashioned alliances and institutions that would foster a liberal order to enable peace and prosperity for much of the world while ensuring US supremacy and idealism. Post-war US presidents pursued an expansive foreign and trade policy that pushed for greater globalisation through openness to trade and investments and even intervening militarily against forces that threatened world peace. Trump wants to do just the opposite with his 3-D policy of disrupt, disengage and deglobalise. Shades of that agenda played out in his first term itself, as he locked into a trade war with China, pulled out of major international pacts, including the 2014 Paris